

Efrain Plascencia

FORWARD-DEPLOYED AI ENGINEER · 13 YEARS IN AUTOMOTIVE SOFTWARE

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01 PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I build AI tools that real teams use every day, not demos. At GEMMACON North America I write and ship the internal AI tooling we run the business on: agentic research pipelines, document automation, and containerized Python services. Before that, a decade of connected-vehicle software at Toyota, Mercedes-Benz R&D, Hyundai, and PACCAR.

02 CORE COMPETENCIES

Agentic systems · LLM / RAG · Python / FastAPI · Forward-deployed engineering · Requirements & scoping · Technical pre-sales · OTA / telematics / SDV · Cross-functional lead

03 PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE & EDUCATION

EXPERIENCE **Director of AI Deployment & Solutions** APR 2023 — PRESENT

GEMMACON North America · Long Beach, CA (Remote from DFW)

— Joined as OTA Test Manager; promoted twice in two years to Director of AI Deployment & Solutions — leading NA AI systems, commercial strategy, and technical recruiting across Mercedes-Benz, Porsche, and NVIDIA engagements.

— Shipped production AI: an agentic intelligence pipeline with rubric scoring and threshold gating; a containerized FastAPI billing service for NVIDIA; Python pipelines that turn JIRA exports into executive decks and score candidates against job descriptions.

— Built the NA engineering team from scratch — 300% headcount growth — and served as primary technical liaison on infotainment, domain-controller, and SDV programs.

EXPERIENCE **Lead Test Engineer** DEC 2022 — APR 2023

PACCAR · Lewisville, TX

— Led end-to-end validation of a new commercial-vehicle E/E architecture — ECU communication, diagnostics, and backend integration — coordinating Tier-1s and embedded teams to aggressive release milestones.

EXPERIENCE **Senior Test Engineer — Connected Services** MAR 2020 — DEC 2022

Toyota Motor North America · Plano, TX

— Owned end-to-end validation of user-profile, registration, and account-activation flows across app, head unit, and cloud for Toyota connected services — technical escalation and global defect triage with Japan HQ.

EXPERIENCE **End-to-End Quality Engineer** MAR 2017 — MAR 2020

Mercedes-Benz R&D North America · Long Beach, CA

— Led end-to-end testing of integrated vehicle systems — head unit, smartphones, digital assistants (Siri, Alexa), wearables, and IoT devices — on premium infotainment and telematics platforms, closing cross-system integration defects for multi-market launches.

EXPERIENCE **Quality Engineer — Telematics** 2013 — 2017

Hyundai Autoever Telematics America · Fountain Valley, CA

— Designed QA processes for Hyundai telematics — DCM, head unit, and backend connectivity — validating hardware–software integrations across embedded firmware, cloud APIs, and mobile clients in a startup-scale environment.

EDUCATION **Bachelor of Science, Computer Science** 2008 — 2012

California State University, Long Beach · Long Beach, CA

04 TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

AI & AGENTIC SYSTEMS Agentic pipelines, LLM/RAG, scoring rubrics, threshold gating

BUILDING & SHIPPING Python, FastAPI, Docker, REST, python-pptx, Stripe, OAuth, Vercel, Neon, GitHub

AUTOMOTIVE DOMAINS DCM, Infotainment, Telematics, Connected Vehicle, ECU, OTA, ADAS, SDV

SYSTEMS & INTEGRATION Embedded architecture, HIL/vehicle testing, CAN diagnostics, cloud API integration

MIT xPRO 2025 · MBRDNA guest speaker 2025 · English · Spanish

COMPANION SITE